🫙 Soil Jar Test: Lab Sheet · ANSWER KEY

Horticulture 1 · Unit 5 · Level 3 · goes with Soil Analysis Parts 1-2

Name: _____

Question: What percent of sand, silt and clay is in our soil sample, and what is its texture?

Materials

clear jar with lid, soil, water, ruler, calculator, texture triangle

⚠️ Safety

- Gloves; wash hands
- Keep dry soil low to avoid dust
- Nothing in mouth

Prediction

Which layer do you predict will be largest?

Answers vary; garden soils are often silt or sand heavy.

Procedure

1. Add soil and record depth.
2. Add water, close, shake 10 s.
3. Settle overnight.
4. Measure each layer.
5. Calculate percents.
6. Name soil on the triangle.

Data

Layer	Depth (cm)	Percent
Sand	**1.5**	**50%**
Silt	**0.9**	**30%**
Clay	**0.6**	**20%**
Total	**3.0**	100%

Expected results (your class data may differ).

Analysis (Claim, Evidence, Reasoning)

1. Claim: what is your soil's texture? Evidence: your percents. Reasoning: how this soil will drain and hold water.
Example: 50/30/20 is a loam; drains moderately and holds water well.

🔑 *Key written by our team from the class teacher's lab sheets, please check.*